



Working to relieve the

HEADS UP! - May 2025 - Edition 34



Our Weekender is back!
Yarnfield Park, Staffordshire
6th to 8th of June 2025
With our Wellbeing Conference
Saturday the 7th of June 2025
Limited Availability
Available to Book Now!



IIH UK: Members ONLY:
Membership starts at just £5
All members will receive
details via email
Any queries please message us

How to Help

Find out some free ways you can
support us on Page 18

Membership Renewal

Don't forget that
membership can now be renewed
online.

[https://www.iih.org.uk/product/107/7/
membership_renewal](https://www.iih.org.uk/product/107/7/membership_renewal)



IIH Intervention Trial is recruiting. See page 3-4

Looking after the IIH
Brain is vital

We need research to
help Dr's make the best
clinical care decisions

IIH Intervention Trial: Which is best in IIH- CSF Shunting or Venous Stenting?



To open the hyperlinks in this newsletter from your lap top/PC simply hold down the ctrl key
then left click the link or just tap the link from your smart phone.

IIH UK research - participants needed

We have recently learnt that the IIH Intervention trial has not recruited as many patients as it needs and if recruitment does not pick up it may be closed. This would be a disaster as we really need this research trial to answer an especially important question:

“Which is better to save vision in those with sight threatening IIH? CSF shunting or venous stenting?”

See page 3-4 for more information and how to take part.



On 16th May we celebrated our 17th Birthday! Who would have thought we'd get to where we are today. Funding research and offering our HOPE programme for people with IIH and parents of children with IIH.

Thank you to everyone who has volunteered for us, fundraised for us and supported us over the years.

Our success is down to you!

Rare disease day 2025 - 28th Feb.

Rare disease day was the perfect opportunity to spread awareness of IIH, and to get our friends/family or work colleagues onboard. Rare Disease Day 2025 carried a simple but powerful message: **More Than You Can Imagine**. It's a reminder that rare diseases touch more lives, involve more conditions, and require more action than most people realise.



Important message from IIH UK. We want to talk about the importance of taking part in research.

The IIH Intervention trial has not recruited as many patients as it needs and if recruitment does not pick up it may be closed. This would be a disaster as we really need this research trial to answer an especially important question.

IIH is under-researched, and a 2015 Cochrane review found insufficient evidence to recommend or reject any current treatments used for treating people with IIH. In 2017 we collaborated with the James Lind Alliance to find the top 10 research priorities in IIH. By creating this priority setting partnership we aimed to identify the top 10 research priorities identified not just by doctors but by people with IIH, their families and carers.

You can read about it here <https://www.iih.org.uk/.../IIH-PSP-top-10-report.-final> and on the James Lind Website here <https://www.jla.nihr.ac.uk/priority-setting.../IIH/>

IIH UK's hope for the research priorities was to ensure that future research in IIH focused on questions and outcomes important to individuals with IIH and those treating them and ensure Funding is allocated to these areas.

#10 of the top ten research priorities is 'Which is the best type of intervention to treat IIH and when should surgery be performed?'. This brings us back to the IIH Intervention trial.

The question posed in this trial is : "Which is better to save vision in those with sight threatening IIH? CSF shunting or venous stenting?"

There are many centres around the world doing both of these procedures but there has NEVER EVER been a robust randomised trial comparing the procedures based on outcomes important to people with IIH. From listening to the people we support we know that it can be a postcode lottery, at the moment doctors do not know which is the best intervention, shunt or stent, and sometimes it can be down to the doctors or hospitals preference.

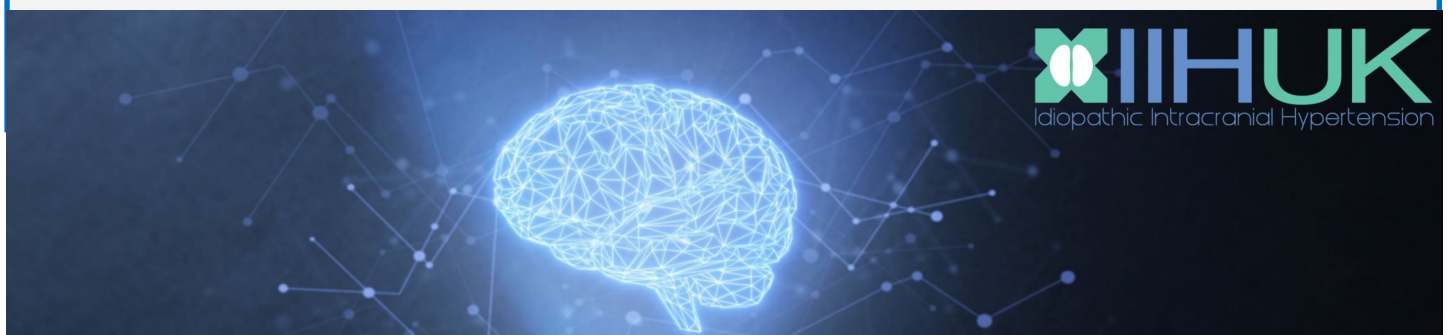
IIH UK supported the grant application for this trial because we know that having high quality research evidence is vital to decide which intervention is best for people with IIH based on research, not preference. On completion of this trial we will know which is the best procedure to save vision and ALSO which has the least risks and complications.

IIH is a rare disease and getting funding from national agencies to do research is extremely difficult. Clinical trials typically cost > £1.5 Million to conduct. To get research funding, the research idea has to compete in front of leading international scientists in a 'dragons' den' like situation with other diseases like cancer, dementia etc. The University of Birmingham led by Professor Sinclair have the funds for this trial and it would be a terrible waste for it to fail because of a recruitment issue. If the trial does not recruit it may force closure, it will also affect other future research bids in the area of IIH.

So, WE NEED YOUR HELP! Please spread the word to support the IIH Intervention Trial.

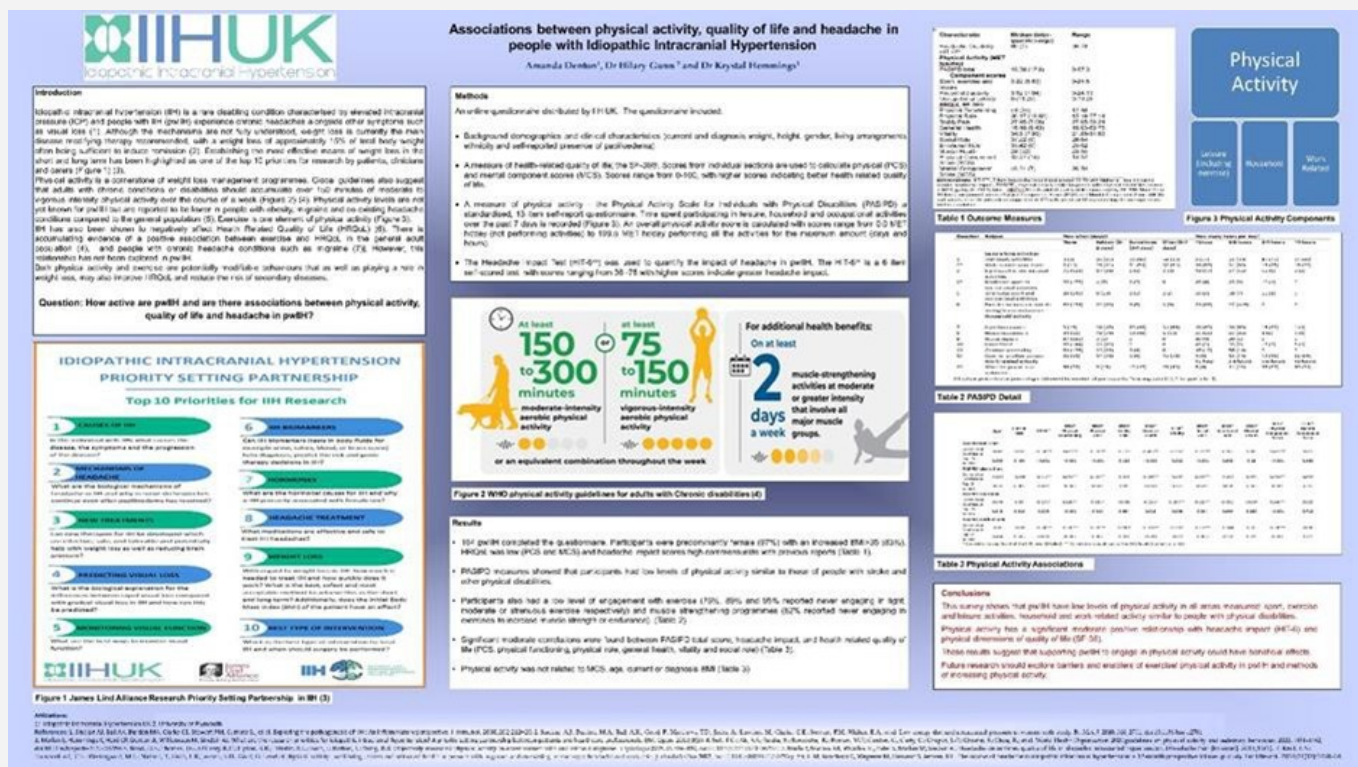
You can look at the eligibility criteria here:

<https://www.isrctn.com/ISRCTN57142415> to see if you are eligible. If you are eligible and are interested in taking part, please contact your IIH doctor and ask to be put forward to the trial.



Back in 2019 we ran a physical activity, quality of life and headache impact in people with Idiopathic Intracranial Hypertension survey. The survey contained measures of physical activity, quality of life and headache impact. The results showed that people with IIH have low levels of physical activity and take little exercise. Physical activity is related to quality of life in people with IIH. The results suggest that improving physical activity in people with IIH could positively impact on quality of life and that ways to increase physical activity such as exercise should be further explored. We found that existing exercise video's were unsuitable for people with IIH and decided to explore ways to change this.

The poster of the results is below:



On Thursday 22nd February IIH UK Trustees Clare, Amanda and Shelly and Team member Katie joined Fit1Life at their studio in Christchurch to record a series of exercise video's specifically for people living with IIH. We all know that IIH is not exclusive to those living with obesity and wanted the video's to represent all body type's and ages so recruited two people with IIH who lived locally to take part but unfortunately both were too ill to attend on the day.

Thanks to Amanda and Katie we still managed to record all sessions and are excited to share them with you. The video's cover Warm up, strength, balance, cardio, combined, mind mapping and cool down. You can find them all on our YouTube Channel here:

<https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCEpwmN0MWtQ-6hRSL4A1Vpw>

Here are a few photo's of the day



Our new HOPE programme was launched in March 2022 and we were overwhelmed with applicants for the online programme so much so that a parallel course was set up. IIH UK also funded a parent carers course for parents of children with IIH.

IIH UK is delighted that over 500 people with IIH have now undertaken the HOPE course which is now fully funded by your fundraising so that it is free for IIH UK members to undertake.



The next programme for adults with IIH and their carers / parents starts in September, you can book your place here:

https://coventryhls.eu.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_3HHkn8cNELN9Ito

Our 2024 round of funding was granted to Dr Anna Carlson. Titled: Does the Hope Programme for Idiopathic Intracranial Hypertension have a long-term impact on mental wellbeing? We will share the results with you in due course.

Praise and feedback for the HOPE programme include:

"It has given me a good insight into how others with the same condition manage on a daily basis. It has changed my way of thinking about living with the condition entirely."

"The programme has been a breath of fresh air and a place to explore the condition safely and confidently. The tasks, videos and information were really engaging and relevant. Thank you."

"The course has allowed me to reflect on my strengths and use those strengths to be a more productive and happy person; instead of sulking about the things I may not be able to do anymore, I have been able to begin a process of adapting to my limitations and finding new things to pursue and enjoy."

"This course has helped me to discover that I can still have a happy, hopeful and fulfilling life with my long-term health conditions. I do not have to let my conditions define me, but they are a part of me."

"I am more understanding of my own condition and that the feelings I have of uselessness are unfounded to some extent. I shouldn't beat myself up for not being ok every day. take my time and set myself simpler goals that are achievable."

Tanya heard about the HOPE programme from IIH UK. She shares her story of discovering the course on the [HOPE website](#).

'I was angry at life' she remembers. "I felt lost. IIH is 'idiopathic'- there aren't any answers, no reason for it. Nobody understands what you're going through. There was no-one who could really relate to the situation I was in. I was angry with the world"

Thank you to the [British Orthoptic Society](#) for promoting the HOPE programme for people with IIH. This is great news, as it means that clinicians looking after people with IIH will have more awareness of the course, and be able to recommend it to a wider range of people that may benefit.



2025 IIH UK Members Conference and Weekender

We are very excited that our Weekender is only 5 weeks away and are hoping you can attend. Spaces are filling up fast, if you are planning on attending please don't leave it too late to book, you will find the details on how to book on page 11.

If you have already booked we are very excited to welcome you to conference on June 7th. Due to Yarnfield Parks GDPR regulations they are not able to share your names with us so if/when you have booked, and you haven't already done so, can you please email secretary@iih.org.uk to let us know you are attending conference and include your name and the names of anyone attending with you. Please put 'IIH UK Conference booking' in the subject line. Day delegates have been emailed to request your dietary requirements, please respond if you have not already done so.

This year's focus is on 'Wellbeing' and we have some excellent clinician presentations lined up including:

Dr Sui Wong, IIH UK Patron, Consultant Neurologist, Guys and St Thomas' Trust. Researcher and Author of Mindfulness for Brain Health will be joining us and will be leading sessions on mindfulness for brain health and talking about why looking after your wellbeing is important for people with IIH. Dr Wong will also be joining our expert panel to answer your questions about IIH.

Professor Alex Sinclair will be joining us to share the latest in IIH research including an exciting new trial that is starting soon. The 'Home based' trial will mean that no travelling to the research facility will be required allowing more people to take part. Both men and women can take part in this trial. Professor Sinclair will also be joining our question and answer panel which will give you the opportunity to put your questions to her as one of the leading researchers in IIH in the UK.

2025 IIH UK Members Conference and Weekender

Nuala Donovan is one of the only physiotherapists in the UK who specialises in IIH. Nuala carried out research funded by IIH UK looking at exercise in people with IIH and how physiotherapy can help them. In 2024 we funded a series of activity and exercise videos with 1FitLife. Specifically designed by Nuala based on her research for people with IIH. Nuala will be leading sessions looking at movement for body and mind. She will also join our panel of experts to answer your questions.

Dr Anna Carlson will be joining us from Hope For The Community CIC. Over 500 people have undertaken the IIH UK funded HOPE self management programme for IIH since it was co-created by people living with IIH and Coventry University. 'it's like having therapy at your fingertips' HOPE participant feedback. Anna will be leading sessions looking at sleep, stress and fatigue in people with IIH. Whether or not you have undertaken the HOPE programme these sessions will support you with strategies to use at home.



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details via email
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2025 IIH UK Members Conference and Weekender

CONFERENCE BOOKING DETAILS

There are several booking options for this event. Come for the whole weekend including attendance at our conference, stay one night and attend the conference or come as a day delegate only.

Please read all of these directions before booking.

To attend for the whole weekend.

Go to www.yarnfieldpark.com and click 'Book a Room'

1. Book the night of Friday 6th June, enter the number of adults (1 or 2)
2. Under where it says 'Checkout' click on 'Enter promo code here' the code to use is YARIIHUK25 and click apply. This will ensure you get our special 24 hour rate which includes conference attendance. Find the room you want to stay in (there are 4 accessible rooms available so if you need one of these rooms please book as soon as you can as rooms cannot be reserved), and click 'Book Now'. This will take you to the check out page. At the top of this page you will see 'Add Room' Click it and do the process again for the night of 7th June. (Note: If booking on phone the 'Add room' will be found by clicking the three dash menu. If you can't find it just make 2 separate bookings and Yarnfield park will pair them together)
3. Fill out your contact and payment details then confirm booking.
4. The next page tells you your booking was successful. You have now booked your place/s at our Weekender and Wellbeing conference and will receive a confirmation email.

2025 IIH UK Members Conference and Weekender

To attend the Friday night and Conference.

As above but check out without adding the second night. You have now booked your room for 1 night and attendance at our wellbeing conference.

To attend the conference then stay the Saturday night

Please book your room as above for Sat 7th June and purchase your conference ticket as a day delegate. (see below)

To attend the conference - as a day delegate

Please visit

https://www.iih.org.uk/product/112/7/iih_uk_wellbeing_conference_ticket

to purchase the places you require. Day delegate tickets include break refreshments and lunch.

Children

Children are very welcome at our weekender and conference. (Children are ages 0-11) If bringing children with you **DO NOT** book online. Instead please call Yarnfield Park and ask to speak to Natalie Stokes on 01785 762907.

Please quote our code which is; YARIIHUK25 when booking to get our special rate. She is available Monday – Friday between 8:45am and 17:15pm. If she is not available another staff member can take your booking. Remember the nights to book are Friday 6th (and Saturday 7th if staying both nights)

We are busy finalising the conference programme and will confirm all details in the coming weeks.

IIH UK Members conference Saturday 7th June 2025

Post code for your Sat Nav is: ST15 0NL. Free parking. Nearest station is Stone which is 3 miles from the venue.

Local Taxi companies: Star Taxi - 01785 822822. Secure Cabs - 01785 812805. Uber also operate in the area.

Join us in the Victory Suite from 08:30am for 09:00am start.

Programme		
9:00 - 9:10	Welcome and Housekeeping	Shelly Williamson and Amanda Denton
9:10 - 9:20	IIH UK Patron – Why is wellbeing important in IIH	Dr Sui Wong
9:20 - 10:15	Live well with HOPE - The importance of sleep and relaxation	Dr Anna Carlsson
10:15 - 10:45	The benefits of mindfulness for brain health	Dr Sui Wong Main Room
	Movement for body and mind	Fionnuala Donovan Breakout room
10:45 - 11:15	B R E A K	
11:15 - 11:45	Movement for body and mind	Fionnuala Donovan Breakout room
	The benefits of mindfulness for brain health	Dr Sui Wong Main room
11:45 - 12:30	Live Well with HOPE - Managing stress and the science of self-compassion	Dr Anna Carlsson
12.30 - 13.30	L U N C H	
13:30 - 13:50	IIH Research – Update on current and future trials! 1. Which is best to save vision in IIH, CSF shunting or venous sinus stenting?	Mr George Tsemoulas
13:50 - 14:10	2. Latest research findings in headache Presenter Dr Yiangou	Dr Andreas Yiangou
14:10 - 14:30	3. The up-and-coming trial evaluating Munjaro in IIH (IIH advance)	Professor Alex Sinclair
14.30 - 15.15	IIH – Q & A with the experts	All speakers
15:15 - 15:45	B R E A K	
15:45 - 16:00	Working with IIH	Lisa Garrity
16:00 - 16:15	Crystals and IIH	Hollie Clarke
16:15 - 17:30	Bingo and Raffle	Shelly Williamson and Amanda Denton

Subject to change



Welcome to the IIH UK Weekender, we hope you enjoy your time with us at Yarnfield Park.

Post code for your Sat Nav is: ST15 0NL. Free parking. Nearest station is Stone which is 3 miles from the venue.
Local Taxi companies: Star Taxi - 01785 822822. Secure Cabs - 01785 812805. Uber also operate in the area.

What's on and where this weekend?

Friday 6th June	Check in from 4pm.
Dinner	In The Restaurant. 6:00 - 7:30pm
After Dinner	Join us in the bar.
Saturday 7th June Breakfast	Served in The Restaurant from 7:00 - 8:30 am
Conference	Join us in the Victory Suite from 8:30am for 9:00am start
Days events	See conference programme
Dinner	In The Restaurant 6:00 - 7:30pm
After Dinner	Join us in the Bar for fun and laughter.
Sunday 8th June Breakfast	Served in The Restaurant from 7:00 - 8:30am
Check out at 10am	We'll be in the foyer for goodbye hugs. See you next year!

If you experience any problems please don't hesitate to approach
one of the trustees.

We celebrated Rare Disease Day 2025

28th February 2025 was [Rare Disease Day](#), a day in which awareness is raised globally for rare diseases of all kinds. IIH is classified as a rare disease, and we love to see people getting involved for this annual awareness day. Rare Disease Day saw people raising awareness on social media, as well as the global chain of lights to spread hope and solidarity. Check out the [Rare Disease Day website](#) and social media to find out how you can take part next year.

Brain Awareness Week

10th-16th March was #BrainAwarenessWeek, organised by the [Dana Foundation](#). In this special week, organisations from around the world bring the fun and excitement of brain science to their communities through a wide variety of activities.



IIH Awareness Month

Don't forget that September is IIH awareness month! It is the perfect opportunity to raise awareness of IIH, and share this time with the IIH community to uplift each other.



Working to relieve the pressure!

IIH UK would not be here if it wasn't for our fantastic volunteers that assist in raising awareness, creating resources as well as linking with key researchers and other organisations in the field.

We pride ourselves as a charity run solely by volunteers from their own homes. Having no paid staff or buildings to maintain means that every penny raised for us really does go towards us helping you!

Volunteers week is June 2nd-8th June, we would like to take this opportunity to say a massive thank you to our volunteer team!



It's time to say thank you



#VolunteersWeek



Our Fabulous Fundraisers!



Katie Hillier ran her first half marathon, the Bathhalf which took place in March in support of one of her closest friends who lives with IIH. Katie said 'It means a lot to be able to raise money for this charity after seeing firsthand the impact IIH has and any donations are so appreciated'. She has raised an amazing £405! her page is still open to donations here:

<https://www.justgiving.com/page/katie-hillier-1735931215657>



During the half-term break, pupils in St Cuthbert's House, Bedford School offered their time and effort to help around the house in return for a small charity donation. We checked their page on JustGiving today and so far they have raised a whopping £855 inc gift aid. Thank you Laurence for organising this fundraiser.

A BIG Shout out to Jordan Baxter who took part in the Yorkshire 3 Peaks Challenge on 3rd May raising an amazing £816!



A big well done and thank you to Jordan who in September 2024, braved jumping out of a plane at 15,000ft, in aid of IIH UK, raising an amazing £573.



A big thank you to anyone not listed here, we could not continue the work we do without you.

If you have taken part in a fundraising event and would like it to appear on our website or in our newsletter please email fundraising@iih.org.uk or newsletter@iih.org.uk to let us know all about it.

Help us raise funds!



Did you know that you can use the following platforms to raise funds for us.

JustGiving - Donate or set up a fundraising page at www.justgiving.com/iihuk

Easyfundraising - shop online at www.easyfundraising.org.uk/causes/iihuk/ and raise funds for us whilst you shop.

The Giving Machine— give as you shop <https://www.thegivingmachine.co.uk/causes/iih-uk/>

Join our lottery and win up to £25,000!
www.theweatherlottery.com/charitiesHomepage.php?client=IIHUK

You can donate at the Charities Aid Foundation - www.cafonline.org/system/charity-search-results

Create a **birthday fundraiser on fb** www.facebook.com/pg/IIHUKCharity/fundraisers/?ref=page_internal

Donate with **PayPal Giving** - www.paypal.com/uk/fundraiser/charity/49628

Selling on eBay? Why not give a percentage to IIH UK via **eBay for Charities** - www.charity.ebay.co.uk/charity/IIH-UK/49628

Buy from our **Teespring store** - <https://iih-uk.creator-spring.com/>

Donate via **Charity Choice** - www.charitychoice.co.uk/idiopathic-intracranial-hypertension-united-kingdom-181486

Membership renewal is now available

HERE



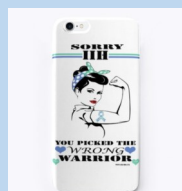
Joshua Morrison ran the Milton Keynes Marathon on 5th May. His daughter was diagnosed with IIH following months of debilitating headaches.

Thank you Joshua, we can't wait to see you with your marathon medal.

You can find Joshua's JustGiving page here, it stands at a whopping £2165.42 inc Gift Aid!!!



Visit our Teespring Store for clothing, mugs, bags and more



www.teespring.com/en-GB/stores/iih-uk



We are collecting foreign coins and banknotes as well as old British currency to help raise valuable funds for IIH UK. We will be collecting at our member conference on Saturday 7th June or you can send to us at: IIH UK, 19 Woburn, Washington, Tyne and Wear. NE38 7JX

Please donate:

- Any currency, any age.
- Foreign coins and foreign banknotes.
- Old British and Irish currency.
- All world coins and notes.
- Pre-euro currency.
- Pre-decimal currency.
- Obsolete coins and notes.
- Damaged and rusty currency.
- Gold and silver coins.

Anything that is or was once money can be donated. You can help without putting your hand in your pocket by simply sorting out any leftover foreign banknotes and coins from holidays and business trips. Any old British or Irish coins and notes can also help. Old pre-decimal coins such as farthings, 1d pennies, three and six pence pieces, shillings and crowns are also welcome. So please seek out those old Euros, American Dollars, Thai Baht, Swiss Francs, German Marks, etc., anything - even obsolete currency can help us. Even your spare change! Foreign coins and small banknotes cannot be exchanged at banks and travel bureaus. Therefore, instead of letting your foreign currency sit in a drawer please consider donating it to help IIH UK.

DONATE YOUR OLD OR FOREIGN COINS & BANKNOTES TO HELP



Send to: IIH UK, 19 Woburn, Washington, Tyne and Wear, NE38 7JX

- ✓ All foreign coins & banknotes
- ✓ Current UK coins and banknotes
- ✓ Any old British & Irish money
- ✓ Even obsolete currency!

Currency services supplied by  cash4coins



Ways you can support us...



We understand that the current economic situation is making money tight for a lot of people. Below are some ways you can still support us with your existing shopping. Each of the methods listed below costs you nothing extra!

You can raise FREE donations for IIH UK every time you shop online. Just use easyfundraising.org.uk
Over 4,000 shops and sites will donate, including all the big names like John Lewis, BT, Expedia, Argos, ASOS, Just Eat, Uswitch and many more!

www.easyfundraising.org.uk/causes/iihuk/

Make us your favourite charity and there are 3 ways to help.

You can donate a percentage of what you sell directly to IIH UK.

You can find items on our page listed with a donation to IIH UK or at the checkout for any item you can add a donation.

www.charity.ebay.co.uk/charity/IIH-UK/49628

You **Shop**
Retailers **Donate**
To **Causes**
For **FREE**



£31M
Raised



Support us





Did you know we have a subscription with Benefits & Work which allows our members to access their range of publications.

The informative guides cover a range of issues relating to disability and benefits.

These guides are available free of charge to Members request. Click [HERE](#) for details

Benefits and Work Guides you can trust



WWW



[IIH UK National Charity](#)

IIH UK National Charity is the main Facebook page for sharing information to everyone on Fb.



[IIH UK on Instagram](#)

We are new to Instagram but are slowly building our followers.



[IIH UK Website](#)

Our website has three areas.

1. People with IIH.
2. Family, friends, carers.
3. Professionals.

It is where you can find all of our information leaflets, research news and **members area**.



[@IIHUK](#)

@IIH UK is where we share information on X (formerly Twitter)



[IIH UK YouTube](#)

Our You Tube Channel is where you will find all of our educational video's and webinars.

Postal Address

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WWW